

- D. Reaction formation

Answer: A

Explanation: Projection at the delusional level is classified as a narcissistic defense in Vaillant's hierarchy. It involves attributing one's own unacceptable thoughts or feelings to others. Passive aggression (immature) involves indirect expression of hostility. Distortion (narcissistic) involves reshaping external reality to meet internal needs. Reaction formation (neurotic) involves behaving opposite to unconscious impulses.

7. According to Freud's structural theory, the Superego is best characterized by which of the following?

- A. It is the first psychic component to develop
- B. It contains the life and death instincts
- C. It represents internalized parental and societal standards of behavior
- D. It operates exclusively in the unconscious

Answer: C

Explanation: The Superego represents internalized parental and societal standards of good and bad behavior. It is the last component to develop (not the first), usually works with the Ego to regulate the Id, and while it has unconscious elements, it is not exclusively unconscious. The Id contains the life and death instincts.

8. A surgeon who is about to perform a high-risk procedure mentally rehearses all possible complications and plans responses to each before entering the operating room. This best represents which mature defense mechanism?

- A. Suppression
- B. Altruism
- C. Anticipation
- D. Humor

Answer: C

Explanation: Anticipation is a mature defense mechanism that involves realistic planning for future discomfort or challenges. Suppression involves consciously postponing attention to a conflict. Altruism involves dedicating oneself to the needs of others. Humor involves finding comic elements in a difficult situation.

9. A patient with chronic pain repeatedly visits her physician with new somatic complaints

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Explanation: Acting out is classified as an immature defense mechanism. Humor is a mature defense. Distortion is a narcissistic defense. Rationalization is a neurotic defense. Vaillant's four levels are: I. Narcissistic (denial, delusional projection, distortion), II. Immature (fantasy, projection, passive aggression, acting out, somatization, regression, introjection, blocking), III. Neurotic (intellectualization, reaction formation, displacement, repression, rationalization, etc.), IV. Mature (humor, sublimation, suppression, altruism, anticipation).

12. A resident physician feels intense anger toward a demanding patient but instead treats the patient with exaggerated kindness. This best represents which defense mechanism?

- A. Sublimation
- B. Altruism
- C. Reaction formation
- D. Suppression

Answer: C

Explanation: Reaction formation is a neurotic defense mechanism in which a person behaves in a manner opposite to their true unconscious feelings. Sublimation (mature) channels impulses into socially acceptable activities. Altruism (mature) involves genuine dedication to others' needs. Suppression (mature) is the conscious postponement of distressing thoughts.

13. In Freud's structural theory, the Ego's involuntary control function primarily serves to:

- A. Respond to external environmental stimuli
- B. Repress the Id's impulses
- C. Internalize societal moral standards
- D. Generate sexual and aggressive drives

Answer: B

Explanation: According to Freud's structural theory, the Ego exerts involuntary control specifically to repress the Id. The Ego also exerts voluntary control to respond to stimuli. Internalizing societal moral standards is the function of the Superego. Generating sexual and aggressive drives is the function of the Id.

14. A teenager who is failing school begins spending excessive time in elaborate video game fantasies where he is a powerful hero. According to Vaillant, this most likely represents which defense?

- A. Narcissistic distortion
- B. Schizoid fantasy

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- C. Intellectualization
- D. Sublimation

Answer: B

Explanation: Schizoid fantasy (fantasy) is classified as an immature defense mechanism in Vaillant's hierarchy. It involves retreating into fantasy to resolve conflict and meet gratification needs. Narcissistic distortion involves reshaping reality to an extreme degree. Intellectualization is a neurotic defense involving abstract thinking. Sublimation is a mature defense channeling impulses productively.

15. Which of the following defense mechanisms is considered most adaptive and associated with the best psychological outcomes?

- A. Projection
- B. Regression
- C. Rationalization
- D. Anticipation

Answer: D

Explanation: Anticipation is a mature (Level IV) defense mechanism associated with the most adaptive functioning. Projection is immature/narcissistic. Regression is immature. Rationalization is neurotic. Vaillant demonstrated that the use of mature defenses (humor, sublimation, suppression, altruism, anticipation) correlates with better mental health outcomes.

16. A patient who experiences anxiety when confronted with a conflict-laden topic suddenly becomes unable to recall what he was saying and changes the subject. This best exemplifies which defense mechanism?

- A. Repression
- B. Blocking
- C. Isolation
- D. Denial

Answer: B

Explanation: Blocking is an immature defense mechanism that involves a temporary or transient inhibition of thinking, often when conflict-laden material is approached. Repression (neurotic) involves the involuntary exclusion of material from consciousness entirely. Isolation (neurotic) separates thought from affect. Denial (narcissistic) involves refusing to acknowledge a painful reality.

17. According to Freud's structural theory, which psychic component operates entirely according to the pleasure principle, without regard for reality?

- A. Ego
- B. Superego
- C. Id
- D. Preconscious

Answer: C

Explanation: The Id operates entirely according to the pleasure principle—seeking pleasure and avoiding unpleasure without heeding reality. It is derived from instinct (sex/libido and aggression) and operates under the influence of life and death instincts. The Ego operates according to the reality principle. The Superego applies moral constraints.

18. A combat veteran refuses to discuss his deployment but channels his experiences into writing a critically acclaimed war novel. Which defense mechanism best describes this?

- A. Suppression
- B. Intellectualization
- C. Sublimation
- D. Rationalization

Answer: C

Explanation: Sublimation is a mature defense mechanism that involves channeling unacceptable impulses or distressing experiences into socially valued activities such as art, literature, or sports. Suppression (mature) involves consciously deciding not to think about something. Intellectualization (neurotic) involves detaching emotion through abstract thought. Rationalization (neurotic) involves creating logical justifications.

19. A patient who unconsciously hates his mother brings her flowers every week and tells everyone what a wonderful relationship they have. The Ego defense operating here primarily protects against which source of anxiety?

- A. Reality anxiety from external threats
- B. Neurotic anxiety from Id-Ego conflict
- C. Moral anxiety from Superego demands
- D. Existential anxiety from awareness of death

Answer: B

Explanation: Reaction formation (the defense being used here) primarily protects against neurotic anxiety, which arises from conflict between the Id's unacceptable impulses and the Ego. The hostile feelings toward the mother represent Id impulses that the Ego manages by producing the opposite behavior. Moral anxiety arises from Superego-Ego conflict. Reality anxiety comes from external threats.

20. Which of the following correctly describes passive aggression as classified by Vaillant?

- A. A mature defense involving indirect expression of anger through helpfulness
- B. An immature defense involving indirect expression of aggression toward others
- C. A neurotic defense involving displacement of anger to a substitute target
- D. A narcissistic defense involving projection of hostility onto others

Answer: B

Explanation: Passive aggression is classified as an immature (Level II) defense mechanism in Vaillant's hierarchy. It involves expressing aggression toward others indirectly (e.g., procrastination, intentional inefficiency, sulking). It is not a mature, neurotic, or narcissistic defense. Displacement (neurotic) involves redirecting emotions to a different target overtly.

21. A physician known for using humor during rounds to defuse tension with patients and colleagues is employing which category of defense according to Vaillant?

- A. Narcissistic
- B. Immature
- C. Neurotic
- D. Mature

Answer: D

Explanation: Humor is explicitly classified as a mature (Level IV) defense mechanism in Vaillant's classification. Mature defenses include humor, sublimation, suppression, altruism, and anticipation. These are the most adaptive defenses and are associated with positive psychological outcomes and healthy functioning.

22. A hospitalized patient who is angry about her diagnosis begins demanding constant attention from nurses, throwing objects when frustrated, and behaving like a much younger child. This regression to earlier behavior is classified in Vaillant's system as which level of defense?

- A. Narcissistic
- B. Immature

- C. Neurotic
- D. Mature

Answer: B

Explanation: Regression is classified as an immature (Level II) defense mechanism in Vaillant's hierarchy. It involves reverting to earlier, more primitive modes of behavior in response to stress. Narcissistic defenses include denial, delusional projection, and distortion. Neurotic defenses include intellectualization and repression. Mature defenses include sublimation and humor.

23. According to the material presented, Anna Freud's primary contribution to psychoanalytic theory was her work on:

- A. The structural theory of Id, Ego, and Superego
- B. Ego defenses
- C. The classification of defenses into four hierarchical levels
- D. The role of mature defenses in positive psychology

Answer: B

Explanation: Anna Freud is credited with developing the concept of ego defenses (defense mechanisms of the ego), building on her father Sigmund Freud's structural theory. Sigmund Freud developed the structural theory (Id, Ego, Superego). George Vaillant developed the hierarchical classification of defenses into four levels and studied their role in positive psychology.

24. A patient who consciously decides to put aside worries about a biopsy result until after his daughter's wedding so he can be fully present demonstrates which defense mechanism?

- A. Repression
- B. Denial
- C. Suppression
- D. Isolation of affect

Answer: C

Explanation: Suppression is a mature defense mechanism that involves the conscious, deliberate decision to postpone attention to a conflict or distressing thought. It differs from repression (neurotic), which is involuntary and unconscious. Denial (narcissistic) involves refusing to acknowledge a reality. Isolation of affect (neurotic) involves separating the emotional component from the thought without consciously choosing to delay it.

25. A patient with borderline personality disorder, when asked to discuss her childhood trauma in therapy, suddenly develops numbness in her arms and legs with no neurological findings. This conversion of psychological distress into physical symptoms is best classified as which defense?

- A. Hypochondriasis
- B. Somatization
- C. Regression
- D. Acting out

Answer: B

Explanation: Somatization is an immature defense mechanism in which psychological conflict or distress is converted into physical symptoms. Hypochondriasis (also immature) involves excessive preoccupation with having a serious illness based on misinterpretation of symptoms. Regression (immature) involves reverting to earlier behaviors. Acting out (immature) involves expressing unconscious emotional conflicts through actions rather than words.
